

Two Witnesses, One Sealed Israel

The Two Houses, the 144,000, and the Witness to the Nations

A Midrash Study on Revelation 7, 11, and 14

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai. Septuagint readings are marked and quoted from Brenton. Greek and Hebrew words are given with Strong's numbers so you can check every one yourself. Torah is referred to throughout as the instructions of YHWH.

HOW TO READ THIS STUDY

This teaching connects several passages that Scripture places side by side but never fully explains. So every section is marked for where it stands. A **conviction** is well grounded in the text. A **proposal** has real scriptural bridges, but no verse states it outright. A **possibility** fits the text but should never be built on.

Where Scripture stops speaking, we stop calling it a commandment. Take these verses, open them yourself, and let YHWH show you.

The teaching in one view

1. **The two witnesses are the two houses.** Judah and Joseph, also called Ephraim.
2. **They are the two lampstands,** fed by the anointing pictured as two olive trees.
3. **They may stand under two anointed leaders,** carrying the ministries of Moses and Elijah.
4. **They may be the 144,000,** both houses sealed as servants of Elohim.
5. **They may be sent two by two to the nations,** the seventy two nations divided at Babel, to reclaim them for Elohim.
6. **They are killed, raised, and caught up** at the seventh trumpet, with all who belong to Messiah.
7. **They are Ezekiel's army,** raised by the breath of Elohim, with Joel's outpoured Spirit and Joel's remnant on Mount Zion.

SECTION I

The Two Witnesses Are the Two Houses

I will give power to my two witnesses, and they will prophesy one thousand two hundred sixty days, clothed in sackcloth. These are the two olive trees and the two lampstands, standing before Adonai of the earth.

REVELATION 11:3-4

1. Revelation defines its own lampstands

The seven lampstands are seven assemblies.

REVELATION 1:20

The Greek word is λυχνία (*luchnia*, G3087). John has already told us in chapter 1 what a lampstand is in this book: a people, an assembly. He never redefines it.

2. John doubled Zechariah's lampstand

Zechariah saw **one** lampstand (Hebrew *menorah*, H4501) with two olive trees beside it (Zechariah 4:2-3). John sees **two** lampstands. If the witnesses are two men, the change from one lampstand to two does nothing. If a lampstand is a people, the change says the one people of Zechariah's day now stands as two.

3. The resurrection language is Ezekiel 37

After the three and a half days, the breath of life from Elohim entered into them, and they stood on their feet.

REVELATION 11:11

The breath came into them, and they lived, and stood up on their feet, an exceedingly great army. Then he said to me, Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel.

EZEKIEL 37:10-11

Out of every resurrection passage in Scripture, John reached for the one YHWH himself defines as a people. Ezekiel then joins two sticks, one for Judah and one for Joseph, the stick of Ephraim, into one stick in YHWH's hand (37:16-22). The Hebrew for stick is *etz* (H6086), the ordinary word for wood or tree.

4. The singular corpse

Revelation 11:8 reads τὸ πτώμα αὐτῶν (*to ptoma auton*), literally "their corpse," singular (G4430). Verse 9 uses the singular again, then switches to the plural τὰ πτώματα (*ta ptomata*). English Bibles smooth this to "bodies." Many scholars treat the singular as ordinary Greek idiom, so this is a supporting detail, not proof, but it fits a corporate reading naturally: two who lie as one body.

5. The beast makes war on them the way he makes war on the saints

- The beast will make war with them, overcome them, and kill them. **Revelation 11:7**
- It was given to him to make war with the saints, and to overcome them. **Revelation 13:7**
- The same horn made war with the saints, and prevailed against them. **Daniel 7:21**

The same war and the same outcome, and in Daniel and Revelation 13 the target is a people. The time frame matches too: 1,260 days for the witnesses (11:3), 1,260 days for the woman in the wilderness (12:6), 42 months for the beast (13:5), and time, times, and half a time in Daniel 7:25.

ANSWERING THE OBJECTIONS

Revelation 11:10 calls them "these two prophets" (οὗτοι οἱ δύο προφῆται, G4396). The pronoun in verse 4 is masculine, οὗτοι (*houtoi*), and in the critical Greek text the word "standing" is the masculine ἑστῶτες (*hestotes*), agreeing with the witnesses rather than with the feminine words for olive trees and lampstands. (The Textus Receptus behind the KJV reads the feminine ἑστῶσαι.) Bodies lie in a street, and the whole world looks at them.

Revelation is a vision, and visions personify peoples all the time: Israel is a woman (12:1), Babylon is a woman (17:3), empires are beasts (13:1). Personal language does not settle it either way. That is why this is held as a conviction open to correction.

WHERE THIS STANDS: CONVICTION, WELL GROUNDED IN THE TEXT

Three independent lines point the same direction: the lampstand definition in 1:20, the doubling of Zechariah's lampstand, and the Ezekiel 37 resurrection language.

SECTION II**The Lampstands and the Olive Trees**

Revelation 11:4 calls the witnesses both olive trees and lampstands. Zechariah, the prophet John is quoting, shows how the two relate.

These are the two anointed ones, who stand by Adonai of the whole earth.

ZECHARIAH 4:14

The Hebrew is *shnei vnei ha-yitzhar*, literally "the two sons of fresh oil." *Yitzhar* (H3323) is fresh, shining olive oil. In Zechariah's day they were two anointed leaders: Zerubbabel the governor from the line of David (4:6-10) and Joshua the high priest (3:1-10). So in Zechariah, the **olive trees are the anointing** and the **lampstand is the people** that the oil keeps burning. And the angel explains where the oil comes from:

Not by might, nor by power, but by my Spirit, says YHWH of Armies.

ZECHARIAH 4:6

The olive tree also pictures Israel itself, so the image carries both meanings at once:

- **Jeremiah 11:16.** YHWH called your name, a green olive tree (*zayit ra'anan*, H2132), beautiful with goodly fruit. Verse 17 names the house of Israel and the house of Judah.
- **Hosea 14:6.** Of restored Israel: his beauty will be like the olive tree.
- **Romans 11:17, 24.** Natural branches and grafted branches, one olive tree, one root.

PUT TOGETHER

The two houses are the two lampstands (Revelation 1:20). **The two olive trees are the anointing that feeds them**, pictured in Zechariah as two anointed leaders, a king figure and a priest figure. Israel was called to be a kingdom of priests (Exodus 19:6), and the redeemed are made kings and priests (Revelation 1:6; 5:10).

WHERE THIS STANDS: CONVICTION, WELL GROUNDED IN THE TEXT

The lampstands as the two houses rests on Revelation 1:20. The olive trees as the anointing and its leaders rests on Zechariah 4:6 and 4:14.

SECTION III**Two Anointed Leaders: The Ministries of Moses and Elijah**

These have the power to shut up the sky, that it may not rain during the days of their prophecy. They have power over the waters, to turn them into blood, and to strike the earth with every plague, as often as they desire.

REVELATION 11:6

- **Shutting the sky** is Elijah's sign (1 Kings 17:1), and Scripture says that drought lasted three years and six months (Luke 4:25; James 5:17), the same span as 1,260 days.
- **Waters to blood and every plague** is Moses in Egypt (Exodus 7:20).
- **Fire from their mouth** echoes Elijah calling down fire (2 Kings 1:10) and YHWH's word as fire in the prophet's mouth (Jeremiah 5:14).
- Moses and Elijah stood with Yahshua on the mountain of transfiguration (Matthew 17:3), and Elijah is promised before the great day of YHWH (Malachi 4:5).

Revelation 11 never names the men. It describes their **ministries**. And Scripture itself shows Elijah's ministry arriving through another man: Yahshua said John the Immerser was the Elijah who was to come (Matthew 11:14), and Luke says John came "in the spirit and power of Elijah" (Luke 1:17). Moses and Elijah together are the instructions and the prophets, the two things Yahshua said he came to fulfill (Matthew 5:17).

WHERE THIS STANDS: A POSSIBILITY, NOT A FOUNDATION

The two houses carry the ministry of Moses and the ministry of Elijah, possibly under two anointed leaders. Who those men are, Scripture does not say. Some early writers named Enoch and Elijah instead, since neither died. Keep the word "possibly."

SECTION IV**The Sealed of Israel: The 144,000**

Don't harm the earth, neither the sea, nor the trees, until we have sealed the bondservants of our Elohim on their foreheads! I heard the number of those who were sealed, one hundred forty-four thousand, sealed out of every tribe of the children of Israel.

REVELATION 7:3-4

I saw, and behold, the Lamb standing on Mount Zion, and with him a number, one hundred forty-four thousand, having his name, and the name of his Father, written on their foreheads.

REVELATION 14:1

No verse says the two witnesses and the 144,000 are the same people. But the text builds real bridges between them:

- **Both houses of Israel.**

The 144,000: Twelve tribes, Judah named first, Joseph present (7:5-8)

The Two Witnesses: Two lampstands, the two houses (11:4; Ezekiel 37)

- **Servants who are prophets.**

The 144,000: Called *douloi*, servants (7:3, G1401)

The Two Witnesses: Prophets (11:10). Revelation 10:7 and 11:18 speak of "his servants the prophets"

- **The mouth.**

The 144,000: No lie found in their mouth (14:5)

The Two Witnesses: Fire comes out of their mouth (11:5)

- **Jerusalem and Zion.**

The 144,000: With the Lamb on Mount Zion (14:1)

The Two Witnesses: Killed in the city where their Adonai was crucified (11:8)

- **Faithful to death.**

The 144,000: Follow the Lamb wherever he goes (14:4)

The Two Witnesses: Finish their testimony, then are killed (11:7). Compare 12:11

- **The order of the book.**

The 144,000: Sealed before the trumpets (ch. 7)

The Two Witnesses: Prophecy, die, rise before the seventh trumpet (ch. 11), then stand on Zion (ch. 14)

Sorting the Revelation 7 list by house is worth a look. Judah, Benjamin, and Levi went with the house of Judah (1 Kings 12:21; 2 Chronicles 11:13-14); three tribes, 36,000. The other nine names stand with Joseph: 108,000. That arithmetic is ours, not John's, but it shows both sticks are fully present in the sealing.

The seal is not a shield from the beast

The seal protects the 144,000 from the locust plague of the fifth trumpet (9:4). The witnesses are still killed by the beast. That is consistent: the seal protects from YHWH's judgments, not from the beast's war, which overcomes the saints as well (13:7). Ezekiel 9:4-6 works the same way. The mark, the Hebrew letter *tav* (H8420), spared people from YHWH's judgment, not from all suffering.

STILL OPEN

John hears 144,000 (7:4) and then sees a multitude no one could count, from every nation (7:9). Whether those are one people seen two ways or two groups is debated, and it affects how tightly the 144,000 can be tied to the two houses alone.

WHERE THIS STANDS: A PROPOSAL TO TEST

Both houses, servants who are prophets, Zion and Jerusalem, and a clean order through chapters 7, 11, and 14. A connection we draw, not one John states. Teach it as "here is what I see, test it."

SECTION V**Sent Two by Two to the Seventy Two Nations**

If the 144,000 are the witness of both houses, where does their witness go? This section follows the Septuagint, the Greek translation of the Hebrew Scriptures that the apostles quote again and again. Read through the Septuagint, the nations, the powers over them, and the sending of Yahshua's witnesses all fit together.

WHY THE SEPTUAGINT HERE

The Septuagint was translated from Hebrew manuscripts centuries older than the medieval Masoretic copies behind most English Old Testaments. The New Testament writers quote it often. Luke follows it in his genealogy, naming Cainan son of Arphaxad (Luke 3:36, Septuagint Genesis 11:12-13), and Stephen counts seventy five souls going down to Egypt (Acts 7:14), which is the Septuagint number for Exodus 1:5 and Genesis 46:27. In several places the Dead Sea Scrolls side with the Septuagint against the later Hebrew text, including Deuteronomy 32:8 below.

To be fair, the Septuagint has its own copying problems in places, so each reading should still be tested. But where it agrees with the Dead Sea Scrolls and with the apostles, it carries real weight.

Thread 1: Seventy two nations scattered at Babel

Genesis 10, the Table of Nations, lists the families descended from Noah's sons, and Genesis 11 scatters them at Babel. The Septuagint names **seventy two**. It includes two names the later Hebrew copies do not: Elisa among the sons of Japheth (Genesis 10:2) and Cainan, son of Arphaxad (Genesis 10:22, 24), the same Cainan Luke places in Yahshua's line. The Masoretic text lists seventy.

Thread 2: The nations were given to the sons of Elohim

When the Most High divided the nations, when he separated the sons of Adam, he set the bounds of the nations according to the number of the angels of Elohim. And his people Jacob became the portion of YHWH; Israel was the line of his inheritance.

DEUTERONOMY 32:8-9 (SEPTUAGINT, BRENTON)

The Septuagint reads ἀγγέλων θεοῦ (*angelon theou*), angels of Elohim. The Dead Sea Scroll copy of Deuteronomy (4QDeut-j) reads *bnei Elohim*, sons of Elohim, the same phrase as Genesis 6:2 and Job 1:6. The later Masoretic text reads "children of Israel." Two independent witnesses, both older than the Masoretic copies, agree.

So at Babel, YHWH divided the nations and set them under the sons of Elohim, but kept Jacob as his own portion. The rest of Scripture confirms the picture:

- **Deuteronomy 4:19.** The sun, moon, and stars, the host of heaven, which YHWH allotted to all the peoples, are not to be worshipped by Israel.
- **Daniel 10:13, 20.** The prince of Persia withstands the messenger for twenty one days, and the prince of Greece is coming. Nations have spiritual rulers.
- **Psalms 82:1, 6-8.** Elohim judges in the midst of the elohim. They will die like men. "Arise, Elohim, judge the earth, for you inherit all of the nations."

Psalms 82 ends with a promise: the nations handed over at Babel will be inherited back by Elohim himself. The witness to the nations is the reclaiming of that inheritance.

Thread 3: Yahshua sent seventy two, two by two

Now after these things, Adonai also appointed seventy two others, and sent them two by two ahead of him into every city and place, where he was about to come.

LUKE 10:1 (SEVENTY TWO, WITH MANY EARLY MANUSCRIPTS)

The seventy two returned with joy, saying, Adonai, even the demons are subject to us in your name! He said to them, I saw Satan having fallen like lightning from heaven.

LUKE 10:17-18

- **Seventy two sent, and seventy two nations.** Luke, who follows the Septuagint elsewhere, records a sending that matches the Septuagint count of the nations.
- **Two by two** is ἀνὰ δύο (*ana duo*). He sent the twelve the same way (Mark 6:7). At the mouth of two or three witnesses a matter is established (**Deuteronomy 19:15**). A witness travels in pairs.
- **And the powers fall.** When the seventy two return, Yahshua says he saw Satan fall from heaven. The sending of the witnesses is tied to the defeat of the rulers over the nations.

HONEST NOTES ON LUKE 10

The Greek manuscripts of Luke 10:1 and 10:17 are almost evenly split between seventy and seventy two, and the WEB follows seventy. Many modern scholars favor seventy two, partly because Luke follows the Septuagint. Either number points back to the Table of Nations.

The seventy two were sent to the towns on Yahshua's road to Jerusalem (Luke 9:51; 10:1), not to the nations themselves. Their mission is a picture in the number, a foretaste of the witness that would go to all nations (Matthew 28:19; Acts 1:8).

Thread 4: The survivors of Zion are sent to the nations

I will set a sign among them, and I will send those who escape of them to the nations, to Tarshish, Pul, and Lud, who draw the bow, to Tubal and Javan, to far-off islands, who have not heard my fame, neither have seen my glory. They shall declare my glory among the nations.

ISAIAH 66:19

- **"Those who escape"** is *pleitim* (H6412), from the same root as Joel's *peletah*, the escape "in Mount Zion" (Joel 2:32).
- **The names are the Table of Nations.** Tarshish, Tubal, and Javan are from Japheth (Genesis 10:2, 4), and Lud from Shem (10:22). YHWH sends the survivors back across the map of Babel.
- **A sign among them.** Before they are sent, YHWH sets a sign (*ot*, H226) among them. In Revelation the sealed are marked before they serve.
- **The harvest comes home.** "They shall bring all your brothers out of all the nations for an offering to YHWH" to his holy mountain Jerusalem (Isaiah 66:20).

Revelation follows the same order. Right after the 144,000 stand with the Lamb on Mount Zion (14:1-5), an angel flies in mid heaven with the eternal good news "to every nation, tribe, language, and people" (14:6). The witnesses' testimony reaches "those who dwell on the earth" (11:10), and at the seventh trumpet the cry goes up: "The kingdom of the world has become the Kingdom of our Adonai, and of his Messiah" (11:15). What was divided at Babel is reclaimed. Psalm 82:8 is fulfilled.

ON THE NUMBERS

Spread evenly across seventy two nations, 144,000 is 2,000 per nation, or 1,000 pairs. It is a striking fit, but Scripture never divides the 144,000 this way, and Revelation itself names the nations with a fourfold phrase rather than a count. Share it as an observation, not as a revelation.

A SUKKOT NOTE

Numbers 29:12-34 calls for 13, 12, 11, 10, 9, 8, and 7 bulls over the seven days of Sukkot, seventy in all. Scripture gives the count but never explains it. Linking the bulls to the nations comes from rabbinic tradition, not from the text. What Scripture does say is that the nations will go up to Jerusalem year by year to keep the feast of Sukkot (Zechariah 14:16).

WHERE THIS STANDS: A PROPOSAL TO TEST

Each thread is solid on its own: seventy two nations divided at Babel and placed under the sons of Elohim, Elohim inheriting them back (Psalm 82:8), witnesses sent two by two with the powers falling (Luke 10:17-18), and Zion's survivors sent to the nations (Isaiah 66:19). No verse sends the 144,000 in pairs to the nations. Teach it as a pattern Scripture lays out, and test it.

SECTION VI

Killed, Raised, and Caught Up at the Seventh Trumpet

Follow what happens to the witnesses, word by word:

- **Revelation 11:7.**
Greek: ἀποκτενεῖ *apoktenei* (G615)
What it says: The beast will kill them.
- **Revelation 11:8-9.**
Greek: πτώμα *ptoma* (G4430)
What it says: Their corpse lies unburied three and a half days.
- **Revelation 11:11.**
Greek: πνεῦμα ζωῆς *pneuma zoes*
What it says: The breath of life from Elohim enters them. They are raised.
- **Revelation 11:12.**
Greek: ἀνέβησαν *anebesan* (G305), νεφέλη *nephele* (G3507)
What it says: They went up into heaven in the cloud.
- **Revelation 11:15.**
What it says: Then the seventh angel sounds his trumpet.

They rise and are caught up right as the seventh trumpet sounds. That is the resurrection Scripture teaches for all of Messiah's people:

We will not all sleep, but we will all be changed, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we will be changed.

1 CORINTHIANS 15:51-52

"Changed" is ἀλλάσσω (*allasso*, G236). Paul says **we will all** be changed at one moment. The dead rise first, and "we who are alive, who are left to the coming of Adonai, will in no way precede those who have fallen asleep" (1 Thessalonians 4:15). Yahshua gives the same order: after the tribulation, with a great sound of a trumpet, he gathers his chosen ones (Matthew 24:29-31).

The 144,000 are called firstfruits (ἀπαρχή, *aparche*, G536) and redeemed from the earth (ἀγοράζω, *agorazo*, G59, the same purchase word used for all the redeemed in 5:9). Firstfruits is also said of believers generally (James 1:18) and of Israel itself (Jeremiah 2:3).

WHERE THIS STANDS: CONVICTION, WELL GROUNDED IN THE TEXT

The witnesses are killed, raised, and caught up in the cloud at the seventh trumpet, together with all who belong to Messiah. Revelation 11, 1 Corinthians 15, 1 Thessalonians 4, and Matthew 24 all agree.

SECTION VII

The Army That Stands Up

So I prophesied as he commanded me, and the breath came into them, and they lived, and stood up on their feet, an exceedingly great army.

EZEKIEL 37:10

The Hebrew is *chayil gadol me'od me'od*, an army great, exceedingly, exceedingly. *Chayil* (H2428) means army, force, strength. This army is the whole house of Israel raised from the dead (37:11) and the two sticks joined in YHWH's hand (37:16-22). It is the very passage Revelation 11:11 quotes. This is the army the two witnesses belong to.

Joel: the Spirit poured out and the remnant on Mount Zion

I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh; and your sons and your daughters will prophesy. And also on the servants and on the handmaids in those days, I will pour out my Spirit.

JOEL 2:28-29

Whoever will call on YHWH's name shall be saved; for in Mount Zion and in Jerusalem there will be those who escape, as YHWH has said, and among the remnant, those whom YHWH calls.

JOEL 2:32

- **Servants who prophesy.** Joel's servants receive the Spirit and prophesy. The 144,000 are servants (7:3), and the witnesses prophesy (11:3).
- **A remnant on Mount Zion.** Joel's remnant is *sridim* (H8300), survivors, and deliverance is *peletah* (H6413), escape, "in Mount Zion." The 144,000 stand with the Lamb "on Mount Zion" (14:1). In Hebrew Bibles this verse is Joel 3:5.
- **The oil.** Zechariah's olive trees pour out oil, and Zechariah 4:6 explains it: by my Spirit. Joel's outpouring is the same oil, and Isaiah 66:19 sends the survivors of Zion out to the nations.

IF SOMEONE BRINGS UP JOEL 2:1-11

Joel defines that army himself: "the swarming locust, the great locust, the grasshopper, and the caterpillar, my great army, which I sent among you" (Joel 2:25). It is judgment sent against Israel, and Revelation 9 reuses it for the fifth trumpet locusts, which are told not to touch the sealed (9:4). The army of the witnesses is Ezekiel's, not that one.

SECTION VIII

Word Study: The Greek and Hebrew at a Glance

Every word below was checked against the Greek text of Revelation and the Hebrew text of the prophets. Look up any Strong's number to verify it yourself.

- **μάρτυς *martys*.**
Strong's: G3144
Where: Rev 11:3
Meaning and why it matters: Witness, one who testifies. The word that later came to mean martyr.

- προφήτης **prophetes**.
Strong's: G4396
Where: Rev 11:10
Meaning and why it matters: Prophet. The text calls the witnesses prophets.
- ἐλαία **elaia**.
Strong's: G1636
Where: Rev 11:4
Meaning and why it matters: Olive tree, quoting Zechariah 4.
- λυχνία **luchnia**.
Strong's: G3087
Where: Rev 1:20; 11:4
Meaning and why it matters: Lampstand. Defined in 1:20 as an assembly.
- ἑστῶτες **hestotes**.
Strong's: G2476
Where: Rev 11:4
Meaning and why it matters: Standing. Masculine in the critical text; feminine in the Textus Receptus.
- πτώμα **ptoma**.
Strong's: G4430
Where: Rev 11:8-9
Meaning and why it matters: Corpse. Singular in 11:8 and the first half of 11:9, plural at the end of 11:9.
- ἀναβαίνω **anabaino**.
Strong's: G305
Where: Rev 11:12
Meaning and why it matters: To go up, ascend. They went up in the cloud.
- σφραγίζω **sphragizo**.
Strong's: G4972
Where: Rev 7:3
Meaning and why it matters: To seal, to mark as owned and protected.
- δοῦλος **doulos**.
Strong's: G1401
Where: Rev 7:3; 10:7
Meaning and why it matters: Servant, bondservant. Used of the 144,000 and of the prophets.
- ἀπαρχή **aparche**.
Strong's: G536
Where: Rev 14:4
Meaning and why it matters: Firstfruits. Also used of all believers (James 1:18).
- ἀγοράζω **agorazo**.
Strong's: G59
Where: Rev 5:9; 14:3-4
Meaning and why it matters: To purchase, redeem. Same word for all the redeemed.

- παρθένος **parthenos**.
Strong's: G3933
Where: Rev 14:4
Meaning and why it matters: Virgin. Read by some literally, by others as covenant faithfulness (2 Corinthians 11:2).
- ἀλλάσσω **allasso**.
Strong's: G236
Where: 1 Cor 15:51-52
Meaning and why it matters: To change. All believers changed at the last trumpet.
- ἀνὰ δύο **ana duo**.
Where: Luke 10:1
Meaning and why it matters: Two by two, in pairs. The witness pattern of Deuteronomy 19:15.
- ἔθνος **ethnos**.
Strong's: G1484
Where: Rev 14:6; Matt 24:14
Meaning and why it matters: Nation, people group. The good news goes to every one.
- **menorah**.
Strong's: H4501
Where: Zech 4:2
Meaning and why it matters: Lampstand. Zechariah saw one; John saw two.
- **zayit**.
Strong's: H2132
Where: Zech 4:3; Jer 11:16
Meaning and why it matters: Olive tree. Used of anointed leaders and of Israel.
- **yitzhar**.
Strong's: H3323
Where: Zech 4:14
Meaning and why it matters: Fresh oil. "Sons of fresh oil" are the two anointed ones.
- **etz**.
Strong's: H6086
Where: Ezek 37:16
Meaning and why it matters: Wood, stick, tree. The two sticks of Judah and Joseph.
- **chayil**.
Strong's: H2428
Where: Ezek 37:10
Meaning and why it matters: Army, force. Ezekiel's army is resurrected Israel.
- **sarid**.
Strong's: H8300
Where: Joel 2:32
Meaning and why it matters: Survivor, remnant, on Mount Zion.

- **palit.**
Strong's: H6412
Where: Isa 66:19
Meaning and why it matters: One who escapes, a survivor. Sent to the nations to declare YHWH's glory.
- **goy.**
Strong's: H1471
Where: Gen 10:5, 32
Meaning and why it matters: Nation. The families of the Table of Nations, 72 in the Septuagint.
- **ἄγγελος *angelos*.**
Strong's: G32
Where: Deut 32:8 LXX
Meaning and why it matters: Angel, messenger. The Septuagint says the nations were bounded by the number of the angels of Elohim.
- **bnei Elohim.**
Strong's: H1121, H430
Where: Deut 32:8 DSS
Meaning and why it matters: Sons of Elohim, the Dead Sea Scroll reading, as in Genesis 6:2 and Job 1:6.
- **tav.**
Strong's: H8420
Where: Ezek 9:4
Meaning and why it matters: Mark. The mark on the foreheads before judgment, the background of the seal.

SECTION IX

Why It Matters: The Sticks Only Join in His Hand

None of this is a spectator sport. If the two witnesses are a people, you are not watching the account, you are in it. And the thing that keeps the two sticks apart is the same thing that keeps any two people apart.

Ephraim won't envy Judah.

ISAIAH 11:13

For he is our peace, who made both one, and broke down the middle wall of separation, that he might create in himself one new man of the two, making peace.

EPHESIANS 2:14-15

Envy is pride wearing a coat. The houses do not become one by winning the argument. They become one in YHWH's hand (Ezekiel 37:19), and a hand that is still gripping an offense cannot be placed in his. Pride is the root of unforgiveness. Humility is the root of forgiveness. Forgiveness is the root of deliverance.

And a witness goes out in pairs. You cannot walk two by two with someone you are still holding a record against. Notice what the witnesses wear: sackcloth (Revelation 11:3). The witness is clothed in repentance. The ones marked in Ezekiel 9 were the ones who sighed and cried over the sin around them, starting with their own. That is who carries the seal, and that is who gets sent.

ASK YOURSELF

Am I more eager to be right about who the witnesses are than to be one of them?

Who would YHWH pair me with, and is there anything between us that needs to be forgiven first?

SECTION X

Questions for Discussion

1. Revelation 1:20 defines a lampstand as an assembly. Is there any place in Revelation where a lampstand means one person?
2. Why would John change Zechariah's one lampstand into two? What else could explain it?
3. Read Revelation 11:4-12 and list every detail that sounds like individual men. How does a corporate reading answer each one?
4. Does a seal that protects from YHWH's judgments but not from the beast's war change how you read Revelation 7 and 9?
5. Deuteronomy 32:8-9 in the Septuagint places the nations under the angels of Elohim and keeps Jacob as YHWH's portion. How does Psalm 82:8 answer that?
6. When the seventy two returned, Yahshua saw Satan fall (Luke 10:17-18). What does the sending of witnesses do to the powers over the nations?
7. Isaiah 66:19 sends Zion's survivors to the names of Genesis 10. How does that reshape the scattering at Babel?
8. Where is the line between a strong interpretation and a commandment? Which parts of this study sit on each side?

SECTION XI

Cross Reference Index

Primary texts: Revelation 7:1-17; Revelation 11:1-19; Revelation 14:1-7

Lampstands and olive trees: Zechariah 3:1-10; Zechariah 4:1-14; Revelation 1:12-20; Jeremiah 11:16-17; Hosea 14:6; Romans 11:16-24

The two houses: Isaiah 8:14; Isaiah 11:12-13; Jeremiah 3:18; Ezekiel 37:15-28; Hosea 1:11; Zechariah 11:7; Ephesians 2:13-16

Death and resurrection language: Ezekiel 37:1-14; Revelation 11:7-12; Daniel 7:21, 25; Revelation 13:5-7; Revelation 12:11

Moses and Elijah: Exodus 7:20; 1 Kings 17:1; 2 Kings 1:10; 2 Kings 2:11; Malachi 4:5-6; Matthew 5:17; Matthew 11:14; Matthew 17:3; Luke 1:17; Luke 4:25; James 5:17

The seal and the mark: Ezekiel 9:4-6; Deuteronomy 6:8; Revelation 7:2-8; Revelation 9:4; Revelation 13:16-17; Revelation 14:1; Revelation 22:4

The nations: Genesis 10:1-32; Genesis 11:1-9; Deuteronomy 4:19; Deuteronomy 32:8-9; Psalm 82; Daniel 10:13, 20; Isaiah 66:18-21; Zechariah 8:23; Zechariah 14:16; Matthew 24:14; Revelation 7:9; Revelation 14:6

Two by two: Deuteronomy 19:15; Mark 6:7; Luke 10:1-20

Resurrection at the trumpet: Matthew 24:29-31; 1 Corinthians 15:20-23, 51-52; 1 Thessalonians 4:15-17; Revelation 11:15

Spirit and remnant: Zechariah 4:6; Joel 2:28-32; Acts 2:16-21; Isaiah 66:19

Firstfruits and redemption: Jeremiah 2:3; James 1:18; 1 Corinthians 15:20, 23; Revelation 5:9; Revelation 14:3-4

Unity and humility: Isaiah 11:13; Ezekiel 37:19; Ephesians 2:14-16; Ephesians 4:32; James 4:6

NOTES

Personal Notes and Convictions

Walk in truth. Walk in Light. Shalom.

Kingdom Life Ministry

Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.